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Team Project: Secure Student WIL Hours Tracker

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Communication Security Briefing

1. Introduction

Communication Security refers to the protection of information and communication systems from unauthorized access, modification or disruption by ensuring that information always remains confidential, accurate and available to authorized individuals.

The Secure Student WIL Hours Tracker project will process student information, attendance records, mentor approvals and project documentation. As a result, communication security controls are essential to protect project information.

2. Purpose of COMSEC

The COMSEC is meant to:

Protect sensitive information from unauthorized access.

Ensure that information remains accurate and trustworthy.

Prevent information leaks and security breaches.

Promote compliance with cybersecurity and privacy requirements.

3. COMSEC Rules

Rule 1: Protect Credentials

All the team members must:

Have strong passwords.

Never share login credentials with other users.

Keep usernames and passwords confidential.

Enable Multi-Factor Authentication.

Report compromised accounts immediately.

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Students, mentors and administrators will use login credentials to access the Secure Student WIL Hours Tracker and by protecting these credentials helps prevent unauthorized access to the attendance and WIL records.

Rule 2: Protect Sensitive Information

Team members must:

Protect student records.

Protect mentor information.

Protect project documentation.

Share information only with authorized individuals.

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The Secure Student WIL Hours Tracker will contain the student attendance data, mentor approvals and uploaded evidence and this information must be protected against unauthorized access.

Rule 3: Secure Devices

All users should:

Lock devices when left unattended.

Protect mobile devices with passwords or biometric authentication.

Install software updates regularly.

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Students and team members may access the project systems using laptops and mobile devices and these devices must remain secure to prevent unauthorized access.

Rule 4: Verify Information Before Sharing

Before sharing any information, team members should:

Always verify the accuracy of documents.

Ensure attachments are correct and check for sensitive information.

Always confirm recipient details.

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Reports, attendance records and project documentation must be verified before distribution to avoid errors and unauthorized disclosure.

Rule 5: Report Security Incidents Immediately

Incidents should be reported immediately to the security team:

Unauthorized access attempts and Suspicious logins

Data breaches and Malware infections

Lost devices

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Any compromise of project accounts, attendance records or the cloud resources must be reported to the project security team immediately for assessment.

4. Security Principles to be applied:

CIA TRIAD: Secure Student WIL Hours Tracker

Confidentiality

Information should only be accessible to authorized users:

Students can view only their own records.

Mentors can only access relevant student submissions.

Administrators can only manage access based on their assigned roles.

Integrity

Information must remain accurate and protected against unauthorized changes:

Approved WIL hours cannot not be modified by students.

Audit logs should always record all significant actions.

Validation controls should always protect attendance records.

Availability

Systems and information should always remain accessible when needed:

Students must always be able to access their attendance records.

Mentors must be able to approve hours anytime.

Cloud services must support reliable access and backup procedures.

5. Application of COMSEC to the team project: Secure Student WIL Hours Tracker.

The Secure Student WIL Hours Tracker applies COMSEC principles through:

Role-Based Access Control

Multi-Factor Authentication

POPIA Compliance Requirements

Audit Logging

Secure Cloud Storage

Data Protection Controls

These controls help ensure that attendance information, WIL hours, uploaded evidence and mentor approvals always remain protected throughout the project lifecycle.

6. Conclusion

A Communication Security is an essential component of the Secure Student WIL Hours Tracker project. By protecting credentials, safeguarding sensitive information, securing devices and reporting security incidents therefore team members can help maintain confidentiality, integrity and availability of project information.

Applying COMSEC principles helps strengthen the project security, support POPIA compliance and promotes responsible information management throughout the project lifecycle.